

Phishing Incident Investigation

1. Project overview

Investigated a phishing-related security alert involving a malicious email attachment delivered to an employee. The objective was to analyze the phishing indicators, validate the threat using previously identified malware intelligence, document findings, and determine the appropriate incident response actions.

2. Key Activities

- investigated a phishing email reported by security monitoring systems.
- Analyzed email headers, sender information and message content
- Identified social engineering indicators and suspicious email characteristic
- Verified a known malicious SHA-256 file hash associated with the attachment
- Evaluated alert severity and potential business impact
- Documented investigation findings in an incident ticket
- Escalated the incident following SOC procedures and playbook guidance

3. Indicator identified

- suspicious sender address
- Mismatch between sender identity and email content
- Password-protected executable attachment
- Known malicious SHA-256 hash
- Grammar and formatting anomalies commonly associated with phishing campaigns

4. Skills demonstrated

- phishing analysis
- Security incident triage
- Email threat investigation
- Malware verification
- SOC operations
- Incident escalation procedures
- Security documentation
- Threat detection and analysis

5. Key learning outcome

This project demonstrated how security analysts evaluate phishing alerts, validate malicious indicators, document findings, and follow incident response procedures. It reinforced the importance of identifying social engineering tactics and applying structured escalation processes within a Security Operations Center (SOC).